

Meta Platforms Inc

Muse Spark(s) Meta's AI Model Launches; Reiterate Overweight & \$825 PT

META shares traded up as much as +9% Wednesday (vs. SPX +3%) as META [released Meta Superintelligence Labs' first model](#), Muse Spark. The model ranks as META's most powerful to-date, & follows MSL's complete rebuild of the AI stack from the ground up. Muse Spark is a natively multimodal reasoning model that supports tool-use, visual chain of thought, and multi-agent orchestration. Spark now powers the newly upgraded Meta AI app & meta.ai website, & will roll out to WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, Messenger, & AI Glasses in the coming weeks. Meta characterizes this initial model as small and fast by design, yet capable enough to reason through complex questions in science, math, and health. Multi-agent reasoning enables Muse Spark to compete w/extreme reasoning modes of frontier models such as Gemini Deep Think and GPT Pro. Importantly, Meta is very clear that Muse Spark is just the beginning. This initial MSL model represents the first step in what Meta believes is a predictable and efficient scaling trajectory in which each generation validates and builds on the last before Meta goes bigger. Larger, increasingly capable models are in development, and Meta will continue to move along the path to personal superintelligence. We believe investor expectations for META's path to the frontier became quite low following 4Q earnings, management commentary in March, & [press reports](#) suggesting further model delays & Meta potentially leveraging Gemini in the interim. **Accordingly, the launch of Muse Spark should provide increased confidence in Meta's scaling trajectory and improve investor sentiment.** We reiterate our Overweight rating & our December 2026 PT of \$825 is based on ~26x our 2027E GAAP EPS of \$31.50.

Overweight

META, META US
Price (07 Apr 26):\$575.05
Price Target (Dec-26):\$825.00

Internet - Large Cap / Mid & Small Cap

Doug Anmuth ^{AC}
(1-212) 622-6571
douglas.anmuth@jpmorgan.com

Bryan M. Smilek
(1-212) 622-8886
bryan.smilek@jpmorgan.com

Margaret Hoffman
(1-212) 622-1710
margaret.hoffman@jpmchase.com
J.P. Morgan Securities LLC

Quarterly Forecasts (FYE Dec)

Adj. EPS (\$)	2025A	2026E	2027E
Q1	7.17	8.25	
Q2	8.11	8.67	
Q3	8.69	8.89	
Q4	9.97	10.34	
FY	33.93	36.16	40.36

Style Exposure

Quant Factors	Current	Hist %Rank (1=Top)			
	%Rank	6M	1Y	3Y	5Y
Value	76	83	81	62	62
Growth	65	80	66	71	45
Momentum	46	20	22	44	66
Quality	17	1	2	13	7
Low Vol	37	41	41	79	29
ESGQ	91	90	96	95	100

Sources for: Style Exposure – J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy; all other tables are company data and J.P. Morgan estimates.

See page 5 for analyst certification and important disclosures.

Price Performance



	YTD	1m	3m	12m
Abs	-12.9%	-10.8%	-11.4%	11.4%
Rel	-9.6%	-9.0%	-7.0%	-19.3%

Company Data

Shares O/S (mn)	2,565
52-week range (\$)	796.25-479.80
Market cap (\$ mn)	1,475,003.00
Exchange rate	1.00
Free float (%)	99.9%
3M ADV (mn)	16.02
3M ADV (\$ mn)	10,210.7
Volatility (90 Day)	37
Index	S&P 500
BBG ANR (Buy Hold Sell)	72 7 1

Key Metrics (FYE Dec)

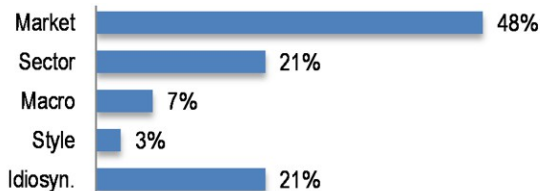
\$ in millions	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E
Financial Estimates			
Revenue	200,966	252,261	294,274
Adj. EBIT	105,213	113,388	124,307
Adj. EBITDA	122,684	142,235	162,147
Adj. net income	87,340	92,980	103,883
Adj. EPS	33.93	36.16	40.36
BBG EPS	30.36	32.69	38.13
Cashflow from operations	115,801	140,954	176,890
FCFF	47,053	10,290	11,357
Margins and Growth			
Revenue Growth Y/Y (%)	22.2%	25.5%	16.7%
EBIT margin	52.4%	44.9%	42.2%
EBIT Growth Y/Y (%)	19.7%	7.8%	9.6%
EBITDA margin	61.0%	56.4%	55.1%
EBITDA Growth Y/Y (%)	20.0%	15.9%	14.0%
Net margin	43.5%	36.9%	35.3%
Adj. EPS growth	22.9%	6.6%	11.6%
Ratios			
Adj. tax rate	19.0%	19.0%	19.0%
Interest cover	105.3	50.5	59.6
Net debt/Equity	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/EBITDA	NM	NM	NM
ROE	43.7%	35.3%	28.7%
Valuation			
FCFF yield	3.2%	0.7%	0.8%
Dividend yield	-	-	-
EV/Revenue	9.3	7.4	6.3
EV/EBITDA	15.2	13.1	11.5
Adj. P/E	16.9	15.9	14.2

Summary Investment Thesis and Valuation

Investment Thesis

We rate Meta Overweight. We believe Meta's virtual ownership of the social graph, strong competitive moat, and focus on the user experience position it to become an enduring blue-chip company built for the long term. Meta is in rarefied air across the combination of scale, growth, and profitability, as the company's massive reach and engagement continue to drive network effects, and its targeting abilities provide significant value to advertisers. Meta is focused on the two big tech waves of AI and Metaverse, and it will spend into those major growth opportunities while also remaining disciplined. We recognize these L-T ambitions are driving increasing infrastructure investments, but we project outsized revenue growth in '26, and Meta has a strong track record of driving returns on increased spending. Our December 2026 PT of \$825 is based on ~26x our 2027E GAAP EPS of \$31.50, further supported by our DCF model.

Performance Drivers



Factors	6M Corr	1Y Corr
Market: MSCI US	0.81	0.73
Sect: Telecom Services	0.66	0.66
Ind: Media	0.66	0.66
Macro:		
Non-Energy Commodity	-0.39	-0.15
Credit Spread	0.23	0.10
US Dollar	0.09	0.07
Quant Styles:		
DivYld	-0.51	-0.40
Growth	0.25	0.32
Value	-0.23	-0.31

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Meta Platforms Inc (*Overweight; Price Target: \$825.00*)

Investment Thesis

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Valuation

Our December 2026 PT of \$825 is based on ~26x our 2027E GAAP EPS of \$31.50, further supported by our DCF model. We apply a premium to the SPX as we have greater confidence in Meta's strong top-line growth and ongoing cost efficiencies. We use this valuation approach as we believe it appropriately balances Meta's valuation relative to its growth and industry peers. Our DCF results in an estimated value of \$825 per share and employs a ~13% WACC and a +10% terminal growth rate.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Downside risks include: **1)** AI investments are heavy & monetization lags, which weighs on GAAP OI, GAAP EPS, & FCF; **2)** slower than expected revenue growth limits AI monetization upside; **3)** competition for online and mobile ad dollars from Google, TikTok, OpenAI, and other online advertising companies; **4)** share structure and Mark Zuckerberg's control; & **5)** regulatory litigations & charges.

Meta Platforms Inc: Summary of Financials

Income Statement - Annual						Income Statement - Quarterly				
	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E		1Q26E	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E
Revenue	164,501	200,966	252,261	294,274	-	Revenue	55,950	60,029	63,209	73,073
COGS	(29,076)	(35,050)	(45,410)	(54,149)	-	COGS	(9,791)	(10,805)	(11,441)	(13,372)
Gross profit	135,425	165,916	206,851	240,124	-	Gross profit	46,159	49,224	51,768	59,701
SG&A	(19,030)	(22,325)	(27,112)	(30,752)	-	SG&A	(5,987)	(6,543)	(6,763)	(7,819)
Adj. EBITDA	102,275	122,684	142,235	162,147	-	Adj. EBITDA	31,439	33,604	35,783	41,409
D&A	(15,498)	(18,616)	(30,048)	(39,101)	-	D&A	(5,909)	(6,748)	(8,204)	(9,187)
Adj. EBIT	87,867	105,213	113,388	124,307	-	Adj. EBIT	25,801	27,170	27,896	32,521
Net Interest	(715)	(1,165)	(2,816)	(2,720)	-	Net Interest	(704)	(704)	(704)	(704)
Adj. PBT	89,151	107,870	114,836	128,302	-	Adj. PBT	26,163	27,532	28,258	32,882
Tax	(8,304)	(25,475)	(13,145)	(13,695)	-	Tax	(2,714)	(2,963)	(3,365)	(4,103)
Minority Interest	0	0	0	0	-	Minority Interest	0	0	0	0
Adj. Net Income	72,183	87,340	92,980	103,883	-	Adj. Net Income	21,184	22,292	22,880	26,624
Reported EPS	23.86	23.49	28.26	31.50	-	Reported EPS	6.49	6.53	6.87	8.36
Adj. EPS	27.61	33.93	36.16	40.36	-	Adj. EPS	8.25	8.67	8.89	10.34
DPS	-	-	-	-	-	DPS	-	-	-	-
Payout ratio	-	-	-	-	-	Payout ratio	-	-	-	-
Shares outstanding	2,614	2,574	2,571	2,574	-	Shares outstanding	2,568	2,570	2,573	2,575
Balance Sheet & Cash Flow Statement						Ratio Analysis				
	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E		FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E
Cash and cash equivalents	43,889	35,873	36,794	33,580	-	Gross margin	82.3%	82.6%	82.0%	81.6%
Accounts receivable	16,994	19,769	19,730	19,128	-	EBITDA margin	62.2%	61.0%	56.4%	55.1%
Inventories	-	-	-	-	-	EBIT margin	53.4%	52.4%	44.9%	42.2%
Other current assets	39,162	53,080	53,080	53,080	-	Net profit margin	43.9%	43.5%	36.9%	35.3%
Current assets	100,045	108,722	109,604	105,788	-	ROE	43.0%	43.7%	35.3%	28.7%
PP&E	121,346	176,400	279,296	407,931	-	ROA	28.5%	27.2%	22.2%	19.5%
LT investments	-	-	-	-	-	ROCE	37.1%	35.0%	28.5%	24.0%
Other non current assets	54,663	80,899	80,899	80,899	-	SG&A/Sales	11.6%	11.1%	10.7%	10.5%
Total assets	276,054	366,021	469,799	594,617	-	Net debt/equity	NM	NM	NM	NM
Short term borrowings	0	0	0	1,500	-	P/E (x)	20.8	16.9	15.9	14.2
Payables	7,687	8,894	14,615	30,604	-	P/BV (x)	8.2	6.8	4.8	3.6
Other short term liabilities	25,909	32,942	38,019	46,354	-	EV/EBITDA (x)	18.2	15.2	13.1	11.5
Current liabilities	33,596	41,836	52,633	78,459	-	Dividend Yield	-	-	-	-
Long-term debt	28,826	58,744	58,744	54,494	-	Sales/Assets (x)	0.7	0.6	0.6	0.6
Other long term liabilities	30,995	48,198	48,198	48,198	-	Interest cover (x)	143.0	105.3	50.5	59.6
Total liabilities	93,417	148,778	159,575	181,151	-	Operating leverage	138.3%	89.1%	30.4%	57.8%
Shareholders' equity	182,637	217,243	310,224	413,467	-	Revenue y/y Growth	21.9%	22.2%	25.5%	16.7%
Minority interests	-	-	-	-	-	EBITDA y/y Growth	31.9%	20.0%	15.9%	14.0%
Total liabilities & equity	276,054	366,021	469,799	594,617	-	Tax rate	19.0%	19.0%	19.0%	19.0%
BVPS	69.87	84.40	120.64	160.63	-	Adj. Net Income y/y Growth	30.9%	21.0%	6.5%	11.7%
y/y Growth	19.9%	20.8%	42.9%	33.1%	-	EPS y/y Growth	31.6%	22.9%	6.6%	11.6%
Net debt/(cash)	(48,989)	(22,848)	(23,769)	(23,305)	-	DPS y/y Growth	-	-	-	-
Cash flow from operating activities	91,328	115,801	140,954	176,890	-					
o/w Depreciation & amortization	15,498	18,616	30,048	39,101	-					
o/w Changes in working capital	1,050	(885)	10,837	24,927	-					
Cash flow from investing activities	(47,150)	(102,003)	(134,844)	(168,936)	-					
o/w Capital expenditure	(37,256)	(69,691)	(132,944)	(167,736)	-					
as % of sales	22.6%	34.7%	52.7%	57.0%	-					
Cash flow from financing activities	(40,781)	(20,370)	(8,416)	(11,169)	-					
o/w Dividends paid	-	-	-	-	-					
o/w Net debt issued/(repaid)	10,432	29,906	0	(2,750)	-					
Net change in cash	2,611	(6,337)	(2,306)	(3,214)	-					
Adj. Free cash flow to firm	54,651	47,053	10,290	11,357	-					
y/y Growth	23.0%	(13.9%)	(78.1%)	10.4%	-					

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.

Note: \$ in millions (except per-share data). Fiscal year ends Dec. o/w - out of which

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Meta Platforms Inc (META, META US) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 27, 2012. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
27-Apr-23	OW	209.40	305
27-Jul-23	OW	298.57	425
04-Oct-23	OW	300.94	400
26-Oct-23	OW	299.53	420
02-Feb-24	OW	394.78	535
25-Apr-24	OW	493.50	480
01-Aug-24	OW	474.83	610
26-Sep-24	OW	568.31	640
31-Oct-24	OW	591.80	660
18-Dec-24	OW	619.44	725
08-Apr-25	OW	516.25	610
01-May-25	OW	549.00	675
04-Jun-25	OW	666.85	735
11-Jul-25	OW	727.24	795
31-Jul-25	OW	695.21	875
30-Oct-25	OW	751.67	800
29-Jan-26	OW	668.73	825

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	Overweight (buy)	Neutral (hold)	Underweight (sell)
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IB clients**	83%	79%	74%
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